

AI Energy: Bigger Than Politeness

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Kontext module 2 [English]

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Notes

- I. Who?: AI users, researchers, and Sam Altman
- II. What? : Saying "please" and "thank you" to AI consumes energy.
- III. When?: January 2026
- IV. Where?: Around the world (e.g., in data centers in New Zealand)
- V. Why?: Because AI needs energy every time it's asked to do something.
- VI. How?: Longer sentences consume a little more energy, but not much.

Main message:

- Kindness toward AI isn't the real issue.
- The real issue is the intensity of our AI use and the size of the systems.

2. Instructions:

- I. Instructions 1:
Could you please give me some simple bullet points for this article based on the 5Ws (Who, What, When, Where, Why, How)?

II. Instructions 2:

Using these bullet points, write a short news article. It should be less than 1000 characters long and easy to understand.

III. Instructions 3:

Make the text more natural and add a short headline.

3. Final Article

Headline: AI Energy: Beyond Politeness

Article: Many online people claim that using polite phrases like "please" and "thank you" in ChatGPT is a waste of energy. However, this is inaccurate. While longer requests do consume slightly more energy, the difference is minimal. The real issue lies in the frequency with which AI is used. With each request, the system needs energy to generate a new response. This process takes place in large data centers, which also consume water and electricity. As AI becomes more widespread, its environmental impact increases. Therefore, rather than worrying about trivial details like politeness, we should focus on our use of AI and its impact on our planet.

4. Reflection

a) Tool selection: Which AI tool did you choose and why. What other tools could you have used instead but didn't.

I used ChatGPT because it's fast and easy. It helps me better understand texts and structure my ideas. I could have used tools like Grammarly or QuillBot, but I prefer ChatGPT because I find it more flexible.

b) Writing with AI: When you use AI tools to assist you in your writing process (production

rather than correction), do you always re-read the result, or do you just copy and paste without thinking too much about contents and structure?

I don't just copy and paste. I always proofread my text and make any necessary changes. This is important because I want to understand what I'm writing and make sure it's correct.

c) My writing style vs. AI's style: How do you deal with the fact that language generated by AI usually differs a lot from your own way of expressing yourself? How do you deal with the transitions between your own writing and AI generated texts?

AI usually writes more formally than I do. I like natural, simple language, so I try to make the text more spontaneous and flowing. Sometimes I edit words and sentences to make it more personal. I also try to better connect my ideas by combining my writing style with artificial intelligence text.